

S05P | Your SPSS field guide

MASY1-GC1015 • Student reference

Open your files, find your code, run with confidence.

SPSS environment routes: VCL, Windows, and Mac

Use one route for this lab. Keep the supplied CSV and `S05P_SPSS.sps` in the same extracted folder. The syntax file is the reproducible working route for this ungraded practice; the menu-only route at the end is an optional appendix.

VCL / AppStream

Upload with My Files, then work inside the remote Windows session.

Windows computer

Extract the download in File Explorer, then open desktop SPSS.

Mac computer

Extract the download in Finder, then open desktop SPSS.

 **Your sequence:** prepare the files → open Syntax Editor → run the chosen block → inspect Output Viewer → save your work.

YOUR SPSS WORKSPACE

Three windows. One workflow.



YOUR CODE

Syntax Editor

Open and run the .sps file



YOUR RESULTS

Output Viewer

Read tables and save .spv



YOUR RECORDS

Data Editor

Inspect rows and variables

SWITCH WINDOWS

Choose Window, then select the editor or viewer you need.

Navigation diagram. Maintained project schematic, not a live screen capture. Choose **Window** to switch among the three SPSS windows.

Route 1: NYU VCL (AppStream Windows)

The streamed desktop is a separate Windows computer. Normal local copy/paste is not a dependable way to move a CSV or syntax file into it.

1. In the AppStream toolbar choose **My Files**, open **Home Folder**, and choose **Upload file(s)**. Upload the lab ZIP, or upload the CSV and .sps files separately.
2. Inside the VCL's Windows File Explorer, open **Home Folder** and extract the ZIP if you uploaded one. Keep the CSV and syntax together in one folder.
3. Open IBM SPSS Statistics from the VCL application launcher. In the tested session SPSS opened directly to the Output Viewer; no startup pop-up appeared. If a welcome/recent-files dialog appears in another session, close it with **X** or **Cancel** so you reach the normal SPSS window. Do not create a second copy of the data.
4. Choose **File > Open > Syntax** and open S05P_SPSS.sps . In the CD line, replace only the folder path with the VCL path, commonly like C:\Users\PhotonUser\My Files\Home Folder\<your-folder> . Keep the quotes and final period.
5. Save a personal syntax copy as S05P_FirstName_LastName_NetID.sps in the same VCL folder. Save the Viewer later as S05P_FirstName_LastName_NetID.spv .

VCL transfer rule: If the clipboard does not move text from your Mac/Windows computer into the streamed desktop, do not keep retrying it. Upload the file through **My Files** and open the file from inside VCL instead. The AppStream **Clipboard** control is useful only when it visibly confirms a text transfer; it is not a replacement for uploading the data file.

Route 2: Windows desktop SPSS

1. Download and extract the student package to a local folder, for example `C:\Users\<you>\Downloads\S05P_Student_Package\`.
2. Open SPSS, choose **File > Open > Syntax**, and open `S05P_SPSS.sps`.
3. Change only the `CD` path to the extracted Windows folder. If a path contains spaces, keep the single quotes around it.
4. Save the syntax copy and output in the same folder. Local Windows copy/paste normally works, but using the supplied files keeps the path and data version auditable.

Route 3: Mac desktop SPSS

1. Download and extract the student package to a local folder, for example `/Users/<you>/Downloads/S05P_Student_Package/`.
2. Open SPSS, choose **File > Open > Syntax**, and open `S05P_SPSS.sps`.
3. Change only the `CD` path to the extracted Mac folder, for example `CD '/Users/<you>/Downloads/S05P_Student_Package'`. Keep the quotes and final period.
4. Use **File > Save As** for the syntax and Viewer output. In some Mac builds the workbook command is **Save a Copy** rather than **Save As**; the file extension still matters.

Excel computer-route notes

The workbook steps are the same on both platforms, but the labels and shortcuts differ slightly.

- **Windows/VCL:** use **Data > From Text/CSV**, **File > Save As**, **Ctrl+S** to save, and **Ctrl+D** for Fill Down.
- **Mac:** use **Data > From Text/CSV** (or **Data > Get Data > From Text/CSV** on an older build), **File > Save a Copy** when Save As is not offered, **Command-S** to save, and **Command-D** for Fill Down.
- **VCL reminder:** these shortcuts act on the remote Windows session. Do not use a Mac Command key inside the VCL; use the Windows labels shown in the streamed desktop.

The three SPSS windows and how to switch

SPSS keeps the data, code, and results in separate windows. Use the SPSS **Window** menu; do not close the Viewer to get back to the code.

- **Syntax Editor:** choose the item ending in `S05P_SPSS.sps – IBM SPSS Statistics Syntax Editor`.
- **Output Viewer:** choose the item beginning with `Output` and ending in `IBM SPSS Statistics Viewer`.
- **Data Editor:** choose the item showing the active dataset name. Use **Data View** for rows and **Variable View** for type, label, missing values, and measurement level.

💡 **Lost your code?** Open **Window**, then choose the entry ending in **Syntax Editor**. Keep the Output Viewer open so your results remain available.

The validated VCL session showed all three choices together under **Window**, with the current window marked by a check.

Run the syntax safely: All versus Selection

The green triangle is **Run > Selection** (also shown as `Ctrl+R` on Windows/VCL). It does **not** mean “run the entire file.”

- To run one lab block, highlight the complete block, including its import/filter command and its final period, then click the green triangle or choose **Run > Selection**.
- To run the complete syntax file, choose **Run > All**. This is the clearest choice for a clean first run.
- Do not press the green triangle with no highlighted block and assume the whole file ran. Re-select the complete block or use **Run > All**.
- Keep `TEMPORARY` and `SELECT IF` attached to the procedure they control. Separating them can change the denominator or produce misleading output.

✅ **One block:** select it, then use the green triangle. **Whole file:** choose **Run > All**.

After a run, switch to **Window > Output Viewer**, use the left outline to find the named block, and confirm that the expected table or chart is present. A green check/status message that SPSS is ready is not, by itself, evidence that the correct block ran.

Optional appendix: do the same checks through menus (no code)

This route is ungraded support and may use different defaults from the supplied syntax. Use the syntax route whenever the lab asks for a named SPSS block or an exact percentile/missing-value convention.

- 1. **Menu import:** choose **File > Import Data > Text Data** (older versions: **File > Open > Data**, with Text/CSV file type) and select `cedar_loop_pickups.csv` . - Wizard step 1: choose **No** predefined format. Step 2: choose **Delimited** and **Yes**, variable names are on the first line. - Step 3: first data case begins on line **2**; read one case per line and all cases. Step 4: select **Comma** only, deselect Space/Tab, and set the text qualifier to a double quote. Confirm five columns in the preview. - Step 5: select each column. Set `pickup_id` to **String** (width at least 8) and `invitation_status` to **String** (width at least 16). Set `delay_flag` , `slow_flag` and `duration` to **Numeric**, retaining the duration's decimal precision rather than an automatic type guess. Step 6: choose **Finish**. - In **Variable View**, confirm text IDs/statuses, numeric flags/duration, Nominal flags and Scale duration. In **Data View**, confirm leading-zero IDs and blank numeric outcomes shown as system-missing, never zero. Menu import does not independently validate malformed source tokens; the supplied H0 syntax performs that validation.
- 2. **Full-frame status check (H0/H1):** choose **Data > Select Cases > All cases > OK**. Then **Analyze > Descriptive Statistics > Frequencies**, move `invitation_status` into **Variables**, and choose **OK**. Check that the status frequencies total **2,400 recorded rows**.
- 3. **Eligible delay checks (H1/H3):** choose **Data > Select Cases > If condition is satisfied > If**. Enter `invitation_status = 'responded' AND (delay_flag = 0 OR delay_flag = 1)` , choose **Continue**, select **Filter out unselected cases**, then **OK**. Run **Frequencies** for `delay_flag` ; inspect its valid 0/1 rows and eligible count.

Quick recovery table

Problem	First recovery action
CSV cannot be found in VCL	Upload through My Files > Home Folder > Upload file(s) , extract inside VCL, and update only <code>CD</code> .
Code disappeared	Window > S05P_SPSS.sps - IBM SPSS Statistics Syntax Editor .
Output disappeared	Window > Output... - IBM SPSS Statistics Viewer .
Green triangle produced the wrong output	Select the complete block, or use Run > All for a clean rerun.
Clipboard transfer failed	Stop retrying local paste; upload the file and open it inside VCL.
Counts/percentages disagree	Check measurement level, missing/sentinel rules, and the denominator before recalculating.

Help boundary: We can clarify an SPSS menu, a file-path error, or what a table means. Use the named checkpoint and troubleshooting section to check your work. This is ungraded practice: no memo, upload, submission or deadline is required.

4. **Restore the full data before H2:** choose **Data > Select Cases > All cases > OK**. Menu filters remain active until reset. Never choose **Delete unselected cases**; keep the original CSV unchanged.
5. **Mean interval check (H2):** choose **Analyze > Descriptive Statistics > Explore**. Move **duration** into **Dependent List**; choose **Statistics**, enable **Descriptives**, set **Confidence Interval for Mean** to **95%**, then **Continue > OK**. In the Output Viewer, read the **Descriptives** mean, sample SD, SE and lower/upper mean limits. The separate Descriptives menu does not supply this interval.
6. Compare each named check with its workbook checkpoint, using the same eligibility rule and units. Menu procedures may have different output headings from the supplied titled syntax. Save optional Viewer evidence with **File > Save As (.spv)** or **File > Export**; keep your supplied syntax copy as optional reproducible working evidence.